

ART

REBEL *Without A* PAUSE

SAFFRONART IS HOSTING A MAJOR AUCTION OF **F.N. SOUZA**'S ART IN DELHI ON SEPTEMBER 14

It's a hundred years since the birth of artist Francis Newton Souza in Saligao, Goa. In honour of this centenary, Indian auction house Saffronart will be hosting *The Works From a Distinguished Private Collection: Francis Newton Souza*, a live auction of his work at The Oberoi New Delhi Ballroom on September 14. In a lead up to this rather special auction, excited art aficionados have been attending by-appointment viewings of these artworks at the Saffronart gallery in Mumbai and in the capital, as well as getting an idea of the various lots on their digital platform saffronart.com; many even placing advance bids. A preview is scheduled on the evening of September 12.

Known for his bold interpretations of the human anatomy (especially his 'heads' and female nudes), and Christianity, Souza courted controversy from his earliest days. Expelled from St Xavier's College in Mumbai for his drawings on restroom walls which were derided as 'obscene graffiti' and then from the Sir J.J. School of Art for active participation in India's struggle for freedom from British rule, the artist didn't flinch from going against the flow. In fact, in the catalogue for his exhibition in a newly independent India in 1948, he wrote about the many

Paint in Me

INDIAN-AMERICAN ARTIST **JOYA MUKERJEE LOGUE**'S DEBUT SHOW IN INDIA AT DELHI'S VADEHRA ART GALLERY IS A MEDITATION ON A LIFE LIVED BETWEEN TWO CULTURES

Indian-American artist Joya Mukerjee Logue's paintings are as much about community, as they are about the memory of women nurturing these communities, painted in her gentle whites and creams. In her debut show in India, *Those who walk before me*, which is on at Delhi's Vadehra Art Gallery until September 12, Mukerjee Logue builds an archive of her dual lives and identities—one rooted and lived in the US, the other featuring her father's ancestral home in Ambala.

"Growing up in America, I always looked forward to my visits to India—my home away from home," says the artist. The exhibition showcases some of the exterior elements of Mukerjee Logue's ancestral home, Rajo Villa, that sits at the heart of the *bazaar* in Ambala, and the neighbouring lanes that branch out from it.

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The selection of 30 oil and watercolours on linen mark a milestone of Mukerjee Logue's decade-long journey as an artist of mixed ancestry







VISUAL POETRY (Clockwise from above) 'Night at Sadar Bazaar, Ambala Cantt', 2004; 'The Roofline', 'Uncovering through the Eyes of a Child', 'Conversations', 2024